

You're Not Locked In Just Because You Didn't Go Out

Channel: Onem · Published: Sep 09, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/AxoH9O7E3Ek> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

The creator argues that "locking in" culture has been co-opted as an excuse to do nothing — real locking in means having actual work to complete, not simply avoiding going out or spending money.

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The "Lock In" Misconception [0:00](#)

- The creator was doing research for a self-improvement September video on TikTok
 - Noticed videos using a dark aesthetic — black Porsches, black-designed houses, luxury imagery
 - A GTA 6 loading screen suddenly appeared on someone's TV in the feed, which sparked the realization
- His conclusion from research — including conversations through members clubs and world travel — is that the current generation of men believe "locking in" simply means **not going out**
 - They equate locking in with: saving money, not socializing, and not doing anything
 - His verdict: "They'd be wrong. It's actually an excuse."

Comparing Lock-In Culture to COVID Excuses [0:48](#)

- He draws a direct parallel between how people used COVID and how they now use lock-in culture
 - During COVID, people rationalized: "I can sit at home, do nothing, play video games — and it's a valid excuse for not having to socialize, progress, or see people."
 - The same logic is now being applied to "locking in"
- The faulty reasoning he's seeing:
 - "While I'm playing GTA, I'm not getting drunk."
 - "While I'm playing GTA, I'm not spending money."
- His response: "No, you're entirely wrong. You couldn't be more wrong if you tried."

What Locking In Actually Means [1:37](#)

- True locking in — sitting with a laptop for hours — is only valid **because you actually have work to do**
 - Once the work is finished, the expectation is to go and enjoy yourself
- The false logic he criticizes: "I'm not doing anything bad, therefore I must be doing something good"

"Locking in is I actually have work to do and I'm going to do it. It's not just sitting inside in the dark and pretending you're doing something of worth or merit."

The 9-to-5 Is No Excuse Either 1:37

- Many people who apply to ONM (his members club) cite a 9-to-5 job as a reason they can't travel or socialize
 - His rebuttal: 9-to-5 workers get days off and weekends
- Personal example: when he had 9-to-5 jobs, he would leave at **4:00 p.m. on Fridays**, go straight to the airport, and fly somewhere
 - Destinations mentioned: Bordeaux, Carcassonne ("Caparay"), Paris, Nice
 - Nice is only about **1 hour 40 minutes** from London by flight
 - Full weekend trip possible: fly out Friday evening, return Sunday night
- He is planning a dedicated video on "life setup for people with 9-to-5 jobs" coming soon